



Business Plan

CLASSMATE APP

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Table of Contents



EXECUTIVE SUMMERY	3
--------------------------	----------

PROBLEM STATEMENT	4
--------------------------	----------

OUR APPROACH	5
---------------------	----------

TARGET AUDIENCE/ICP	6
----------------------------	----------

MARKET ANALYSIS	7
------------------------	----------

FINANCIAL PLAN	8
-----------------------	----------

Executive Summery

BUSINESS NAME:

Classmate

MISSION:

Private tutoring and counseling isn't accessible to all students. Classmate was created by students to increase equity and bring detailed feedback to help all students improve.

VISION:

To make high-quality writing support accessible to every student, empowering them with AI-powered feedback to build confidence, grow academically, and thrive personally.

**Year
Founded:**

2024

Owner:

Sam Cheng

Problem Statement

HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS NEED A BETTER WAY OF GETTING WRITING FEEDBACK BECAUSE PRIVATE COUNSELORS AND TUTORS AREN'T ACCESSIBLE AND WORKING WITH AI ISN'T HELPFUL TO THEIR LEARNING

SCHOOLS NEED A BETTER WAY OF EMPOWERING THEIR STUDENTS TO USE AI FOR WRITING BECAUSE THEY CAN'T COMPLETELY BAN AI USAGE AND CURRENT CHAT-BASED MODELS AREN'T GOOD FOR WRITING HELP.

Our Approach

Web Application

1 — SUBMIT YOUR ESSAY

2 — GET FEEDBACK

3 — REVISE, EDIT, & IMPROVE

CLASSMATE IS AN AI-POWERED WRITING TOOL THAT PROVIDES BOTH HIGH-LEVEL FEEDBACK AND DETAILED INLINE COMMENTS. USING OVER THREE DIFFERENT AI MODELS, IT OFFERS FAST, TAILORED GUIDANCE—INCLUDING SPECIALIZED MODES FOR ESSAYS LIKE COLLEGE ADMISSIONS.

DESIGNED BY STUDENTS AND REFINED THROUGH USER FEEDBACK, CLASSMATE HELPS STUDENTS IMPROVE THEIR WRITING WHILE KEEPING THEIR OWN VOICE.



Nature & Human Identity

Overall Feedback

The essay presents a compelling argument of how nature influences human identity through literary and philosophical reflections.

The natural world has long served as both a sanctuary and a mirror for human identity. Throughout history, humans have sought to understand themselves by observing the intricacies of the natural world, often using it as a metaphor for personal reflection, and meaning. From David Thoreau's meditative observations of Walden Pond to the symbolism of rivers and forests in modern literature, nature reveals truths about human existence that are often obscured by the chaos of society. This essay explores how these elements with nature shape human self-perception and identity through literary examples and philosophical reflections.

Thoreau's *Walden* is a quintessential example of the human quest for self-discovery through nature.

Target Audience/ICP

Understanding our target audience is key to delivering effective, customized marketing solutions. After researching the problem space we've examined and identified recurring characteristics, in demographics, behavior and needs.

IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE: STUDENTS & SCHOOLS

	STUDENTS	SCHOOLS
DEMOGRAPHICS	- Primarily high school students - Innovators and early adopters of new technology - Have some prior experience with AI tools	- Innovative, forward-thinking institutions - Small charter schools and private schools (primary early targets) - More agile decision-making than large public schools
BEHAVIORS	- Actively seek out new products and tools to test - Experiment with AI in their schoolwork or creative projects - Prefer tools that support their own thinking rather than replacing it	- Open to trying new educational tools and teaching methods - Actively look for ways to integrate AI into classrooms responsibly - Prioritize student empowerment and ethical tech adoption
NEEDS	- A better way to improve their writing with AI - Tools that enhance their skills instead of doing the work for them - A trusted, forward-thinking platform to try out responsibly	- A solution that positions them as forward-thinking schools - AI tools that help students grow academically without encouraging misuse - A manageable, safe entry point into AI adoption in education

Market Analysis

Market Competitor Overview

Competitive Landscape

TYPE	WHAT	STRENGTHS	DISADVANTAGES	HOW WE STAND OUT
GRAMMARLY	AI-powered writing assistant	- Plagiarism Checker - CrossPlatform Integration - Widely recognized	- Surface-Level Feedback - Cost Barrier - Equity Gap (Targets professionals and students the same, not really built around student learning)	- Equity Focus w/ student learning - Iterative Feedback - Lower Entry Cost - Specialized Feedback
QUILL BOT	AI-powered online platform and writing assistant	- Popular and well-known writing-assist product. Established market standing - Versatile paraphrasing modes - Reasonable Value - Multiple Language support & translation	- Most sought after features are blocked behind a paywall or premium features - Lacks deep structural feedback / high-level guidance - Mismatched context, tone and voice suggestions	- Strong free tier to drive viral adoption among students - Education first positioning. Meaning guided feedback that maps common rubrics so students and instructors see measurable learning outcomes. - Deeper Feedback on Structure & Argument
CHATGPT	General-purpose AI chatbot created by OpenAI	- Versatile. Able to handle a broad range of tasks beyond writing feedback. - Widely recognized and heavily used - Advanced AI. ChatGPT is built on powerful GPT models with a strong understanding of language and tone	- Not specialized for students but rather general audience - Lack on "in-line" comments. Responses are given as paragraphs or lists without the visual editing - High paywall, not accessible. Once freemium model reaches limit, higher use/ tools are hidden behind a paywall of \$20 a month, making it too expensive for some.	- In-line text suggestions and comments. - Student focused & equity driven - Specialized modes for writing material and suggestions - Community created. For students, by students.

Financial Plan

REVENUE MODEL

Currently Classmate operates on a B2C model, with a freemium model included. However in the near future Classmate will operate on a Business-to-Business model (B2B) to alleviate financial burden from students and to influence maximum use.

PRICING STRATEGY

Within the B2B model, schools are projected to pay an annual per-student license fee: of about \$3-\$8 per year. Pricing tiers may be adjusted based on school size, type (charter, private, public), and level of support provided

LOGIC

The reason we take on these business models is because schools represent a more sustainable and scalable revenue stream compared to individual student subscriptions, and it aligns with our mission to make advanced writing tools accessible to all students. Additionally, annual licensing ensures predictable, recurring revenue and the per-student pricing allows schools of varying sizes to easily adopt Classmate.

Year 1 Projections

Implement a road map of our near future goals

(Can be derived from our next class deliverable or venture pyramid)